

Self healing buildings

A researcher comes up with limestone-producing bacteria that can heal cracks in buildings. <http://dgit.in/1HnkdET>

Blurring the blur!

Microsoft Hyperlapse, the technology that smoothen out your shaky shots! <http://dgit.in/1S1ovYA>

Pirate No More

What you need to DO to go legit

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Piracy is not an alien concept in India. In fact, it's widely accepted as an acceptable behaviour by society, if not the law. One of the prime reasons for this is that even though over the last two decades technology has permeated to every facet of our lives, giving us multiple devices to enjoy content on, we still face issues like availability, insane pricing, inconsistent quality, Internet service issues, etc. In comparison, it's easier to just head on over to your favourite torrent site and queue things for download.

However, over the past two or so years, multiple services have popped up that make it easier, simpler and more affordable to just go legit and not worry about all the hazards that piracy brings. In fact, some of these services are so good and tuned towards the needs of the Indian consumer that they make piracy redundant. Some of these services that we'll talk about haven't been officially launched in India but still do a great job of letting you access content that you wouldn't have been able to otherwise.

Going Legal: Movies & TV shows

Movies and TV shows are probably the most popular type of content when it comes to piracy. A lot of times Indian TV

channels are themselves to blame because of the awful gap between episodes airing in the U.S./U.K. and when they're aired here. Another ridiculous thing that's becoming more and more common here is the stupid amount of censorship on TV which destroys any semblance of enjoyment that you can get from a show. With respect to movies, while most blockbusters get launched here, many interesting, smaller movies don't and you might as well forget about most R-rated movies.

If you're a fan of international movies and TV shows and want to stream them rather than buy them outright, Netflix is



Netflix isn't available in our country yet

for you. You'll also like Netflix if you're more comfortable with the idea of paying a fixed rental every month and getting access to an entire library of movies and TV shows instead of buying or renting movies one by one. Of course, Netflix hasn't been launched in India and if you try to access the website normally, you'll get an error message like this one:

To access Netflix in India, you'll need to use a VPN connection which sounds more intimidating than it actually is. We've already written about how you can do so, and once you have your Netflix account up and running, you'll be able to enjoy movies like *The Wolf of Wall Street* and TV shows like *Breaking Bad* without worrying about censorship in any form.

After a month long free trial, Netflix will cost you \$8.99 (₹550 approx.) every month, which will be charged automatically to your credit card. While that amount is higher than what you pay on average for

a DTH connection, Netflix also gives you much more. You can watch any show at any time and the in-browser player will always remember what part of which episode you last watched. Netflix also has a robust, built-in recommendation service that understands your watching habits and tastes and suggests movies and TV shows. The Netflix player is also intelligent in the way it uses your broadband and automatically improves or reduces video quality based on your Internet connection. As a result, you will rarely be stuck watching a progress bar buffering as you often do in other video streaming services.

Netflix has a couple of drawbacks as well. The biggest one that applies to Indian users is the fact that Netflix hasn't been officially launched in India. Even though you can access it through VPN, the legality of that is often a point of debate. Also, if your favourite VPN service uses PPTP or L2TP protocols, then your ISP can block it. Another drawback is that Netflix's library of new movies isn't all that great and you may find some movies that are only available to rent on DVD (not feasible for Indian users). Netflix also doesn't have



Netflix features exclusive content as well

access to HBO content, so if you want to watch *Game of Thrones*, you'll have to look elsewhere.

Overall though, Netflix is the best current option for fans of international movies and TV shows, and is relatively inexpensive considering the library.



A censored scene from Seinfeld on FX India